LECHLEY ASSOCIATES
Recruitment Specialists

PROFILE

Driven to succeed and highly effective at executive level, I am a motivated and personable leader with success across a wide portfolio. I have nearly three decades of experience in Defence, National Security, and Intelligence. Passionate about technology integration, my expertise lies in the development and implementation of strategies, products, and processes that enhance personnel performance and data driven decision making.

I have delivered strategic success for the most demanding clients in the most challenging environments and place relationships, requirements, and technical understanding at the heart of all that I do. By building partnerships, collaborating with internal and external stakeholders I turn strategy and planning into deliverable results and drive success within my organisation.

KEY SKILLS

- **Capability Development**: Experienced in consulting, testing and implementing new technologies with a development team and developing strategies, operational intelligence tactics and techniques to enhance the performance and effectiveness of personnel and the capabilities developed for them.
- **Innovation**: With a passion for engaging and integrating technology I have designed and helped develop tools to support intelligence products, processes and change management within the workforce and progress the adoption and integration of technological solutions to enhance and improve operational intelligence related activity.
- **Relationships and Engagement**: Effective, experienced executive delivering insight, advice and coherence to organisational demands and mission critical activity. Builder of senior stakeholder relationships and partnerships to deliver strategic, operational and tactical success.
- **Leadership and Management**: A professionally registered Chartered Manager (CMgr MCMI) with more than 25 years of experience as a strong flexible leader of large, diverse multi-disciplinary teams.
- **Problem Solving**: The ability to apply logical thinking to complex problems to produce effective analysis and evidence-based options, enabling senior management to make timely and effective decisions.
- **Communication**: Versatile, clear and sophisticated communicator with ability to convey complex detail in straightforward way, influence and reassure stakeholders and diverse audiences enabling key decisions.

KEY ACHIEVEMENTS

- As the head of a new vertical established a wide, senior and international partner network, managed this network to collaborate against emergent Defence requirements in a resource constrained environment.
- Through technical thought leadership and product refinement enabled the creation of a new product, that was delivered as a system in a new market leading to a 9% increase in revenue for the business; forecast to rise to 16% within 12 months.
- Built an Intelligence department via a wholesale programme of organisational, cultural, business and technological change. The organisation I transformed is now responsible, amongst other successes, for cyber threat intelligence and cyber fusion for the totality the UK's Special Mission Units bespoke C5ISR solutions, globally.
- Intelligence stakeholder for a technical project developing a vanguard data collection and analysis capability within defence that integrated ML into targeting; it received Prime Ministerial interest for its success on operations where it continues to deliver.

PROFESSIONAL EXPERIENCE

Head of Defence **Current**

Executive advisor to the board for all Defence related activity. Responsible for developing and executing strategy and plans to identify, pursue and secure customers and partners in my new vertical.

- I exploited my extensive, specialist experience in the Defence sector, knowledge of technologies in place and end user requirements to redesign a proprietary Data Analytics Framework SaaS product. I worked with the CTO and Product Owner to rearchitect and refine, cutting the backlog by nearly 50% removing impediments and reinvigorating the development team. The redesign enabled a specific ML capability to be separated as a new product.

- I built and maintained a wide partner network across the Defence Industry at a senior level, inclusive of multinational corporations that deliver technology solutions and services, designed to leverage their strengths and capabilities to create winning solutions. This network is principally personal contacts, where I maintain strong relationships at director, SVP and CTO level in addition to my MOD network.

- As a member of the Senior Leadership Team, assumed responsibility for all policies and initiated an internal Corporate Social Responsibility workstrand to enhance Bids and Tenders.

Jun 2022 to Aug 2023

Commander of a Military Intelligence Unit
Full responsibility for the management and output of specialist Intelligence personnel to provide integral support to a national Specialist Mission Unit. Principle advisor to the executive on all matters pertaining to Cyber Fusion, Intelligence, Counter Intelligence and Security.

- Success in designing, prioritising and developing an under resourced team to address a demotivated, inefficient, and distracted workforce resulting in a significantly more effective and motivated workforce.

- Faced with an organisation that had previously had no integral intelligence support I instituted a strategy to inform and cohere requirements from across the organisation, delineate responsibilities with other intelligence departments and centralise focussed output to meet the needs of the organisation to deliver greater effect with the same level of resource.

- Identified the requirement for and assumed responsibility for the workforce and capabilities design as part of a £50+ million business change programme between the UK's Specialist Mission Units and PAG that will deliver ground breaking change and capability enhancement for all organisations.

- Through effective management and problem solving closed the gulf between the technical knowledge possessed by subject matter experts, operational requirements, adversary capability and intent to provide accurate, assured intelligence for the unit's C5ISR development and activity.

Aug 2020 to Jun 2022

Assistant Head of Intelligence
Principle Intelligence Officer providing rapid technical capability development, operational and tactical targeting solutions and intelligence management to a Specialist Mission Unit.

- As a specialist advisor, responsible for the capability development and integration of technology, data science and intelligence tradecraft. I worked intimately with government agencies and the department of an allied nation to enhance a £10 million programme framed as non traditional ISR. I accelerated this innovative and rapid requirement project advising, managing and cohering a team of data scientists, data engineers, developers (predominantly using Python and Java) and intelligence professionals for demanding customers as it evolved at pace in 2021. By 2022 it was and continues to deliver at the forefront for defence and national security objectives.

Military Intelligence Career **2001 to 2020**

A full career spanning tactical, operational and strategic appointments, across MOD, with government agencies and partner nations at home and abroad. Responsibilities included Human Resource management of over 150 employees. Portfolio managed an innovative technical data collection and analysis system to enable strategic collection requirements that was delivered on time and under budget (2.5m). Cohered a XGov common understanding to inform the development of National Strategy. Represented the UK within an overseas Embassy to counter a terrorist threat by providing advice, training and equipment to enhance a Nation's counter terrorist capability.

QUALIFICATIONS and MEMBERSHIPS

Chartered Manager
PG Extended Diploma Strategic Management and Leadership.
Level 7 Award Chartered Management Institute.
Certified Innovation Practitioner.
Oxford University, Said Business School. Oxford Artificial Intelligence Programme.
Oxford University, Said Business School. Executive Strategy Programme.
Professional SCRUM Master.
SANS Incident Response and Management.
AWS Cloud Essentials.
FinOps Product Owner.
Leading SAFe Trained.

Developed Vetting. Renewed 2024